

also be able to set the volume for each sound clip. A drum loop in the background, a few screeches and squeals generously spread out, and your remix is done!

5. Render your mix

Once you've finished concocting your mix, you can export it to nearly any popular audio format—MP3, OGG, WMA, and so on.

6. Take your talents online!

Getting pretty good, eh? Curious to know how you match up against other wannabes across the planet? The ACID Web site, www.acid-planet.com, regularly holds remix contests featuring even big artists such as Madonna and Depeche Mode. They'll provide you with a capella tracks that you must remix, and their crack team of judges will do what they're supposed to—judge. If your remix is the best, it'll get featured on the artist's next album. By the time this issue gets to you, only 20 days will be left for the current contest, so rush in your entry or start practicing for the next one.

8.3 Getting A Bite Of Sound

So you want to make a remix but don't know where to turn for a good loop? Be very careful about what you use in your mixes—using a loop without checking its copyright agreement could result you breaking the law without even realising it till someone sends you a hate-mail calling you a pirate. So there's a tip—*always* read the copyright agreement, even if it's a guaranteed free MP3.

Here's a list of sites that offer royalty-free loop and other random sound effect downloads:

Proloops Freeloops section

<http://www.proloops.com/freeloops.asp>

Though the site's primary function is to let you buy royalty-free loops for your own use, it also has a free section that features around 50 to a hundred free loops every month. The loops will